Kenneth J. Nieser, PhD

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EDUCATION & TRAINING

2023–present	Postdoctoral Fellow, Big Data-Scientist Training Enhancement Program VA Palo Alto Health Care System, Menlo Park, CA
2023–present	Postdoctoral Scholar, Department of Surgery Stanford-Surgery Policy Improvement Research and Education Center Stanford University School of Medicine, Stanford, CA
2018–2023	Ph.D. Epidemiology, Minor in Statistics Department of Population Health Sciences, University of Wisconsin–Madison School of Medicine and Public Health, Madison, WI
2009–2013	B.A. Physics and Mathematics, High Honors Swarthmore College, Swarthmore, PA

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

07/2023–present	Associated Health Fellow, VA Palo Alto Health Care System, Menlo Park, CA
03/2023–07/2023	Health Science Specialist, VA Palo Alto Health Care System, Menlo Park, CA
10/2020–03/2023	Research Assistant, Department of Population Health Sciences, University of Wisconsin–Madison, Madison, WI
09/2018–09/2020	Project Assistant, Department of Population Health Sciences, University of Wisconsin–Madison, Madison, WI
04/2017–06/2018	Senior Analyst, Healthgrades, Madison, WI
07/2015–04/2017	Market Analyst, Healthgrades, Madison, WI
09/2014–07/2015	Healthcare Data Analyst for Wisconsin Medicaid, HP Enterprise Services, Madison, WI
07/2013–07/2014	Technical Services Analyst, Epic, Verona, WI

AWARDS & HONORS

2020	Rankin-Skatrud Travel Award, Department of Population Health Sciences, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, WI
2019	Biology and Medicine through Mathematics (BAMM!) Travel Award, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, WI

2019 Student Research Grants Competition–Conference Presentation Funds, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, WI

2018–2019 New Graduate Student Fellowship, Department of Population Health Sciences, University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison WI

RESEARCH FUNDING

07/2026–06/2031 Title: Racial and ethnic disparities in colorectal cancer screening referral and receipt with impacts on cancer outcomes across VA
Funder: VA Career Development Award-2, VA Office of Research & Development, Health Systems Research Broad Portfolio
Award #: IK2RD000420
Institution: VA Palo Alto Health Care System, Menlo Park, CA
Role: PI

10/2025–09/2026 Title: Utilization and impacts of telehealth among Veterans with positive fecal immunochemical tests
Funder: VA Office of Health Equity, Telehealth Research & Innovation for Veterans with Cancer (THRIVE) Scholars Program
Award #: NA
Institution: VA Palo Alto Health Care System, Menlo Park, CA
Role: PI

10/2025–09/2026 Title: Comparing risk-standardization methods used for facility outlier identification in health care quality measurement
Funder: Center for Innovation to Implementation, VA Palo Alto Health Care System
Award #: 26-KN-1
Institution: VA Palo Alto Health Care System, Menlo Park, CA
Role: PI

PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

1. **Nieser KJ**, Chen C, Harris AHS, Wagner TH, Schmidt EM. Purchasing Versus Providing Care at the VHA: Quality Differences in Follow-Up After Psychiatric Hospitalization. Med Care. 2026 Feb 1;64(2):89-97. doi: 10.1097/MLR.0000000000002271. Epub 2025 Dec 2.
2. **Nieser KJ**, Tancredi DJ, Harris AHS. The Unreliability of Two Publicly Reported Outcome Quality Measures for Characterizing Health Care Quality Within the Veterans Health Administration. Health Serv Res. 2026 Feb;61(1):e70050. doi: 10.1111/1475-6773.70050. Epub 2025 Oct 1.

3. **Nieser KJ**, Ortiz-Torres BS, Cochran AL, Zayas-Caban G. REMLA: An R package for robust expectation-maximization estimation for latent variable models. SoftwareX. 2025 March; 30:102112.

4. **Nieser KJ**, Harris AHS, Binswanger IA, Clark SC, Finlay AK. Legal-involved veterans are less likely to receive guideline-concordant colorectal cancer screening. BMC Health Serv Res. 2025 Mar 4;25(1):333. doi: 10.1186/s12913-025-12490-6.

5. Harris AHS, Davis-Lopez K, Schmidt E, **Nieser K***, Massarweh NN. Landscape of Consensus-Based Entity-Endorsed Perioperative Quality Measures. Ann Surg Open. 2025 Mar;6(1):e559. doi: 10.1097/AS9.0000000000000559. eCollection 2025 Mar. **Interpretation of data; critical revision of manuscript.*

6. **Nieser KJ**, Harris AHS. Comparing methods for assessing the reliability of health care quality measures. Stat Med. 2024 Oct 15;43(23):4575-4594. doi: 10.1002/sim.10197. Epub 2024 Aug 15.

7. Harris AHS, Eddington H, Shah VB, Shwartz M, Gurewich D, Rosen AK, Quinteros B, Wilcher B, **Nieser KJ***, Jones G, Wu JT, Morris AM. Statistical Methods to Examine Racial and Ethnic Disparities in the Surgical Literature: A Review and Recommendations for Improvement. Ann Surg. 2024 Dec 1;280(6):960-965. doi: 10.1097/SLA.0000000000006440. Epub 2024 Jul 9. **Interpretation of data; critical revision of manuscript.*

8. Harris AHS, Liu P, Breland JY, **Nieser KJ***, Schmidt EM. Differences across race and ethnicity in the quality of antidepressant medication management. Health Serv Res. 2024 Oct;59(5):e14347. doi: 10.1111/1475-6773.14347. Epub 2024 Jul 5. **Interpretation of data; critical revision of manuscript.*

9. Pingeton BC, **Nieser KJ***, Cochran A, Goodman SH, Laurent H, Sbrilli MD, Knight B, Newport DJ, Stowe ZN. Childhood maltreatment exposure is differentially associated with transdiagnostic perinatal depression symptoms. J Affect Disord. 2024 Aug 1;358:183-191. doi: 10.1016/j.jad.2024.05.021. Epub 2024 May 3. **Study design; substantial contributions to analysis and interpretation of data; statistical consultation; drafting and revision of manuscript.*

10. **Nieser KJ**, Harris AHS. Split-sample reliability estimation in health care quality measurement: Once is not enough. Health Serv Res. 2024 Aug;59(4):e14310. doi: 10.1111/1475-6773.14310. Epub 2024 Apr 24.

11. **Nieser KJ**, Cochran AL. Quantifying and reducing inequity in average treatment effect estimation. BMC Med Res Methodol. 2023 Dec 15;23(1):297. doi: 10.1186/s12874-023-02104-2.

12. Green RK, **Nieser KJ***, Jacobsohn GC, Cochran AL, Caprio TV, Cushman JT, Kind AJH, Lohmeier M, Shah MN. Differential Effects of an Emergency Department-to-Home Care Transitions Intervention in an Older Adult Population: A Latent Class Analysis. Med Care. 2023 Jun 1;61(6):400-408. doi: 10.1097/MLR.0000000000001848. Epub 2023 May 11. **Study design; substantial contributions to analysis and interpretation of data; statistical consultation; drafting and revision of manuscript.*

13. **Nieser KJ**, Stowe ZN, Newport DJ, Coker JL, Cochran AL. Detection of differential depressive symptom patterns in a cohort of perinatal women: an exploratory factor analysis using a robust statistics approach. EClinicalMedicine. 2023 Mar;57:101830. doi: 10.1016/j.eclinm.2023.101830. eCollection 2023 Mar.
14. **Nieser KJ**, Cochran AL. Addressing heterogeneous populations in latent variable settings through robust estimation. Psychol Methods. 2023 Feb;28(1):39-60. doi: 10.1037/met0000413. Epub 2021 Oct 25.
15. Cochran AL, **Nieser KJ***, Forger DB, Zöllner S, McInnis MG. Gene-set Enrichment with Mathematical Biology (GEMB). Gigascience. 2020 Oct 9;9(10). doi: 10.1093/gigascience/giaa091. **Analysis and interpretation of data; critical revision of manuscript.*
16. Collings P, Goldstein J, Hamilton E, Mercado B, **Nieser K***, Regan M. The nature of the assembly process in chromonic liquid crystals. Liquid Crystals Reviews. 2015 April; 3(1):1-27. doi: 10.1080/21680396.2015.1025305. **Interpretation of data; critical revision of manuscript.*
17. Mercado BR, **Nieser KJ***, Collings PJ. Cooperativity of the assembly process in a low concentration chromonic liquid crystal. J Phys Chem B. 2014 Nov 20;118(46):13312-20. doi: 10.1021/jp510025j. Epub 2014 Nov 11. **Experimental design and acquisition of data; analysis and interpretation of data; computer modeling; critical revision of manuscript.*

SOFTWARE PACKAGES

1. **Nieser KJ**. QualityMeasure: Methods for Analyzing Quality Measure Performance. R package. https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=QualityMeasure
2. **Nieser KJ**, Ortiz-Torres BS. REMLA: Robust Expectation-Maximization Estimation for Latent Variable Models. R package. https://CRAN.R-project.org/package=REMLA

PRESENTATIONS

Invited Presentations

1. **Nieser, KJ.** Investigating the relationship between telehealth and colorectal cancer screening access & equity. Office of Health Equity, Veterans Health Administration. Virtual. December 2025.
2. Harris, AHS, **Nieser, KJ.** Evaluating the Reliability of Measures of Organizational Characteristics: Issues and Recommendations. Center for Dissemination & Implementation at Stanford (C-DIAS) and Prevention Science & Methodology (PSMG) Virtual Grand Rounds. Virtual. September 2025.
3. **Nieser, KJ.** Colorectal cancer screening among legal-involved Veterans. Veterans Justice Programs National Training Call Series, Veterans Health Administration. Virtual. April 2025.

4. **Nieser, KJ.** Quality measure reliability estimates can depend on the method and the population. Office of Performance Measurement, Veterans Health Administration. Virtual. June 2024.
5. **Nieser, KJ.** Optimizing for whom? The role of robustness in equitable algorithms. Machine Learning Day, Arizona State University. Virtual. April 2021.

Oral Presentations

1. Harris AHS, **Nieser KJ**, Godziuk K, Giori NJ. Should High-BMI Total Knee Arthroplasty Patients be Referred to High Volume Hospitals? Rethinking the Surgical Volume-Outcome Relationship. Association of VA Surgeons. Newport Beach, CA. April 2026.
2. **Nieser, KJ.** Statistical challenges in health care provider profiling. Stanford-Surgery Policy Improvement and Education Center, Department of Surgery, Stanford University School of Medicine, Stanford, CA. September 2025.
3. **Nieser, KJ.** Do some VA facilities deliver a higher quality of care than others? Center for Innovation to Implementation, VA Palo Alto Health Care System. Menlo Park, CA. September 2025.
4. **Nieser, KJ**, Harris, AHS. The Unreliability of Two Publicly Reported CMS Outcome Measures When Applied to Veterans Health Administration Facilities. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. Minneapolis, MN. June 2025.
5. Harris, AHS, Davis-Lopez, K, **Nieser, KJ**, Massarweh, NN. Surveying the Landscape of Consensus-Based Entity-endorsed Surgery-related Quality Measures. Annual Clinical Congress of the American College of Surgeons. San Francisco, CA. October 2024.
6. Schmidt, EM, Chen, C, **Nieser, KJ**, Wagner, TH, Harris, AHS. Differences in Follow up after Psychiatric Hospitalizations for VA Purchased Versus VA Provided Care. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. Baltimore, MD. June 2024
7. **Nieser, KJ.** Improving health care equity requires reliable quality measurement. Stanford-Surgery Policy Improvement and Education Center, Department of Surgery, Stanford University School of Medicine. Stanford, CA. September 2023.
8. Hansmann, KJ, Jenkins, M, **Nieser, KJ**, Svenson, E, Walts, Z. PHS Antiracism Initiative: Research Methods Toolkit. Department of Population Health Sciences Monday Seminar, University of Wisconsin–Madison. Madison, WI. April 2022.
9. **Nieser, KJ.** Detecting Inequity in the Analysis of Mental Health. Data Science Research Bazaar: Data Science for the Social Good, University of Wisconsin–Madison. Virtual. February 2021.
10. **Nieser, KJ**, Collings, P. Kinetics of Assembly and Dis-assembly of Structures Forming a Chromonic Liquid Crystal at Low Concentrations. American Physical Society March

Meeting. Baltimore, MD. March 2013.

Poster Presentations

1. **Nieser, KJ**, Gabrielian S, Schmidt, EM, Harris, AHS, Stewart KE, Stimmel, MA, Dunn, A, Finlay AK. Disparities in Antipsychotic Medication Adherence Rates by Legal-Involved Status: An Analysis of Veterans with Schizophrenia and Other Psychotic Disorders. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. Seattle, WA. May 2026.
2. **Nieser, KJ**, Tancredi, DJ, Harris, AHS. Investigating the Tradeoffs between Two Risk-Standardization Methods Used to Profile Health Care Provider Quality of Care. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. Seattle, WA. May 2026.
3. **Nieser, KJ**, Harris, AHS, Binswanger, IA, Clark, SC, Finlay, AK. Disparities in Colorectal Cancer Screening Rates by Legal-Involved Status: An Analysis of Patients of the Veterans Health Administration. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. Minneapolis, MN. June 2025.
4. **Nieser, KJ,** Schmidt, EM, Harris, AHS. Health Care Quality Measure Reliability Estimates Can Hinge on the Method. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. Baltimore, MD. June 2024.
5. Harris, AHS, Eddington, H, Shah, VB, Shwartz, M, Gurewich, D, Rosen, AK, Quinteros, B, Wilcher, B, **Nieser, KJ**, Jones, G, Wu, JT, Morris, AM. Statistical Methods to Examine Racial and Ethnic Disparities in the Surgical Literature: A Review and Recommendations for Improvement. AcademyHealth Annual Research Meeting. Baltimore, MD. June 2024.
6. Harris, AHS, Eddington, H, Shah, VB, Shwartz, M, Gurewich, D., Rosen, AK, Quinteros, B, Wilcher, B, **Nieser, KJ**, Jones, G, Wu, JT, Morris, AM. Statistical Methods to Examine Racial and Ethnic Disparities in the Surgical Literature: A Review and Recommendations for Improvement. ISPOR Europe. Copenhagen, Denmark. November 2023.
7. **Nieser, KJ**, Cochran, AL. Average Treatment Effects in Synthetic Samples with More Equitable Representation. Society for Epidemiologic Research Annual Meeting. Chicago, IL. June 2022.
8. **Nieser, KJ.** Bias Analysis of Depression Rate Comparisons between Racial/Ethnic Groups. Society for Epidemiologic Research Annual Meeting. Virtual. December 2020.
9. **Nieser, KJ**, Stowe, ZN, Cochran, AL. Addressing Heterogeneity in Mental Illnesses through Robust Estimation. Department of Population Health Sciences Annual Poster Session, University of Wisconsin–Madison. March 2020.
10. **Nieser, KJ**, Stowe, ZN, Cochran, AL. Robust estimation for factor loadings with application to postpartum depression. Biology and Medicine through Mathematics (BAMM!) in Richmond, VA. May 2019.

TEACHING

Teaching Associate, Swarthmore College

Spring 2013	General Physics II
Spring 2012	General Physics II with Biomedical Applications
Fall 2011	General Physics I
Fall 2011–12	Spacetime, Quanta & Cosmology

Tutor, Swarthmore College

Spring 2013	General Physics II
Spring 2012	General Physics II with Biomedical Applications
Fall 2011–12	General Physics I

SERVICE

Professional Organization Memberships

2023-	AcademyHealth
2020-2023	Society for Epidemiologic Research (SER)

Professional Organization Activities

2026	Session Chair and Discussant, "Accounting for Complexity: Advanced Methods for Addressing Bias and Heterogeneity." Annual Research Meeting, AcademyHealth. Seattle, WA.
2026	Abstract Reviewer, Annual Research Meeting, AcademyHealth. Seattle, WA.
2022	Abstract Reviewer, Annual Meeting, Society for Epidemiologic Research. Chicago, IL.

Editorial Service

2026	Ad-hoc Reviewer, Medical Care
2025-2026	Ad-hoc Reviewer, Statistics in Medicine
2025	Ad-hoc Reviewer, Journal of General Internal Medicine
2024	Ad-hoc Reviewer, BMC Medical Informatics and Decision Making
2022	Ad-hoc Reviewer, Journal of Medical Internet Research

Institutional Service

2025	Application reviewer, Scientific Portfolio Lead, Center for Innovation to Implementation (Ci2i).
2023	Grant reviewer, University of Wisconsin Institute for Clinical and Translational Research, Translational Basic & Clinical Research Pilot Awards Program

Community Service/Volunteer Activities

2024-2025 Mentor, Stanford Science Small Groups. I mentored groups of 3-5 local community college students to each explore a scientific question of interest (10 weeks in Fall 2024 and in Spring 2025).